

news feed

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hypothesis

Northwood

■ What is it?

Northwood is the core around which the new Intel Pentium 4 processors will run. They will be based on the new 0.13-micron die Tualatin core (116 mm), with copper inter-connectors, will run at speeds of more than 2 GHz and will replace the current Pentium 4 processors.

■ What's the fuss about? Northwood comes with a more compact socket type—the socket 478, also called mPGA478. Its small size allows for a higher density of pins attached on the processor. This entails a shorter distance from each other and to the socket and hence, fewer errors when instructions are transmitted.

It will use 64-bit, 3.2 GBps FSB running at a 100 MHz quadpumped clock speed. This means that it can handle four times as many instructions per clock cycle. Also, its L2 cache will be enlarged (from 256 KB) to a standard size of a 512 KB.

snapshot

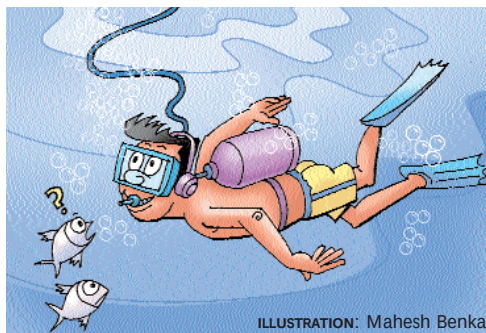
76% is the viewership for television

While the Internet, despite being a popular source of information, enjoys a viewership of just **8%**

Source: www.internetindicators.com

Oceanic Talk

Expecting an urgent call? There's not much you can do if you're 30 feet underwater admiring the lush aquatic life. But that's history now. A new phone devised by France Telecom has made it possible for divers to receive calls from a landline or a mobile phone without having to surface. The phone, which comes with a long wire, is attached to a buoy on the surface of the water.



The buoy contains a GSM unit which picks up the signals and relays it down the wire to the phone.

This phone has a dial pad, a light, a buzzer and a special

mouthpiece. The buzzer and a flashing light alert the diver of an incoming call. The person receiving the call underwater bites on the mouthpiece to receive the call and hears the conversation through sound vibrations that reverberate in the diver's skull

towards his ear. The diver can also talk back and use a dialing pad to call anybody on a fixed or wireless phone. Connectivity now extends to the oceans.

Rip In Peace?

Michael Jackson, Natalie Imbruglia, and the Fast and the Furious are some of the first artistes to employ CDs that use copy protection. A copy-prevention mechanism called key2audio has been used on Michael Jackson's forthcoming single, 'You Rock My World'. This causes a computer's CD-ROM drive to incorrectly interpret the stored data. Key2audio alters an audio CD making it incompatible with CD-ROM, CD-R and CD-RW drives. Similarly, the SafeAudio system developed by Macrovision, prevents one from 'ripping' music CDs to create digital copies on a computer hard disc or for downloading to a portable player. SafeAudio is

based on the work of TTR Technologies, Israel. SafeAudio gives some of the digital code on the CD "grossly erroneous values", adding bursts of hiss to the audio signal. The error-correction codes on



the CD, which normally correct these errors, are distorted. So error correction fails, leaving tiny gaps in the music.

Universal uses Cactus

Data Shield to lock up ordinary CD audio files. But it includes a separate audio player that allows digital versions of songs to be played. These songs cannot be played through common media players such as Windows Media or Winamp. Nor can the digital files be played on anything other than a Windows OS. Interestingly enough, you can beat the protection by playing a CD on a standard CD player, taking the output to the line-in jack on the computer, and recording each track into a WAV file. Once a WAV, the song can easily be converted to an MP3 using any of the programs available on the Net. It's more time consuming compared to a ripper, but it works.

■ Linux breaks 100-Petabyte ceiling ■ AMD now in Indian branded PCs ■ Bug found in Intel Itanium processor ■ The cost of a pirated version of Windows XP in